

NEVER AN ADEYEMI

EPISODE 10: THE FRONT DOOR

PALMFIRE SEASON 1

Screenplay draft

Based on Mario's final story brief and story bible

Contemporary Lagos romance with stakes

FADE IN:

INT. EXECUTOR'S OFFICE - MORNING

The formal offer sits beside the police report. Mr. Obi and Ify sit opposite Mr. Balogun and Mrs. Eze. Tobi waits by the wall.

MR. BALOGUN

The estate shall transfer a forty-percent interest in the Adeyemi operating business to Mr. Obinna Obi, subject to his acceptance.

MR. OBI

I accept.

Ify turns to him.

IFY

You are sure?

MR. OBI

I am sure of what I am accepting. I am not accepting their story about why.

MRS. EZE

The transfer can be recorded in your name first.

MR. OBI

It should be entered in my daughter's name.

IFY

Dad.

MR. OBI

I drove the road. You should own where it led.

MR. BALOGUN

That secondary transfer will require a separate instrument.

MR. OBI

Then prepare it.

He signs the acceptance. Tobi watches the ink dry.

CUT TO:

INT. POLICE ECONOMIC CRIMES DESK - DAY

Kunle and Yewande sit opposite Inspector Abiodun. Mrs. Adeyemi gives her statement in another room.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

You understand the historic ownership dispute is not being decided here.

KUNLE

The company is being punished for a dead man's guilt.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

The company is being asked about a living man's waiver.

YEWANDE

We were trying to prevent a public fight.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

You offered money for permanent silence.

KUNLE

We offered a settlement.

INSPECTOR ABIODUN

A settlement requires a free choice. The estate will decide what happens to the shares. You will answer for what you did to shape that choice.

Kunle looks through the glass at his mother.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI OPERATING BUSINESS - RECEPTION - DAY

The reception is quiet. A notice is placed on the company board: NEW OWNERSHIP INTEREST - OBI FAMILY.

Ify enters with Mr. Obi. Staff look up, unsure whether to greet them.

MR. OBI

You do not have to become them to enter this room.

IFY

I know.

MR. OBI

You do not have to forgive them to work here.

IFY

I know that too.

She touches the notice, then removes the old access card from her father's hand.

IFY

You can stop carrying the keys for everyone else.

MR. OBI

I may need practice.

CUT TO:

EXT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - FRONT GATE - EVENING

Tobi waits outside the large front gate. Ify approaches from inside with a folder.

TOBI

I brought the report number and Afolabi's signed statement.

IFY

My father has the copies.

TOBI

Then I brought them for you.

IFY

You went to the police against your brother.

TOBI

Against what he did.

IFY

That distinction does not repair the memorial.

TOBI

I know.

IFY

It does make tomorrow possible.

Tobi takes that in. It is not forgiveness, but it is not exile.

TOBI

Can I walk with you?

IFY

You can start by walking.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - FRONT DOOR - CONTINUOUS

Ify opens the front door. The house beyond is the same size, but the threshold no longer belongs to one family alone.

TOBI

Do you know where you are going?

IFY

For once.

TOBI

And after this?

IFY

We find out what the company is supposed to become.

From the old hallway, Mrs. Adeyemi watches them enter. She holds an empty key ring. The side gate stands open behind her.

Ify crosses the threshold. Tobi follows. The front door remains open to the road.

FADE OUT.